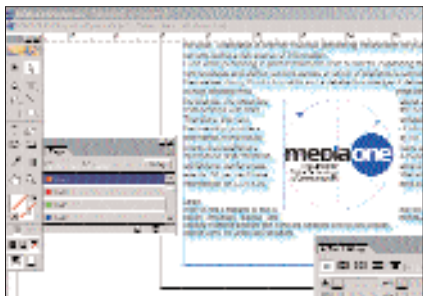


Round 3: Transparency

Most designers who work with images are going to love the transparency features in InDesign. While InDesign natively imports Photoshop files with transparent images, it also allows you to add transparency effects such as Drop Shadow to the text and the imported images. That means you can create rich text effects on the fly without resorting to techniques such as duplicating the text box and placing it behind to give a shadow effect. InDesign has different blending options that define how the colours between two objects will show up when different drop



InDesign allows you to apply different text and image effects and creates transparent layers

shadow effects are applied. You can state the transparency for the effects at the same time.

These enriched features mean that designers can work on a number of text effects in InDesign directly without having to switch to an image-editing tool such as Photoshop every time. Even text wrapping with transparent images is enhanced as you can wrap text around the contours of an image (without actually having to draw a path around the image).

With Quark, you still have to work with clipping paths or Alpha channels in your image-editing software to get transparent images. InDesign gets back into contention with round 3.

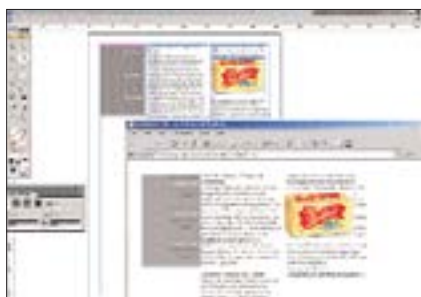
Score: Adobe 1 Quark 0

Round 4: Saving options

Content generators face a regular problem of having to export their documents from Quark, InDesign, PageMaker or any other desktop publishing software to the Web or as a PDF document. With earlier versions of Quark and InDesign, saving for the Web was a tedious process, and the results weren't satisfactory either.

Now, both InDesign and Quark have invested a lot of time in enhancing tools

for saving to the Web. InDesign allows you to directly export documents as an HTML file while in Quark you can create a Web document that can be exported as an HTML file. Quark's HTML rendering seems to be superior when you use the Web document feature. It recognised column layouts and tables that were created, and managed text wraps around images as per HTML standards. With Quark you can even use advanced features such as creating forms and buttons, adding rollover to images, creating image maps, etc all of which were absent in InDesign. Note that during testing, we were unable to resize the Form buttons. At the same time, Quark has integrated Avenue Quark in this version. This allows you to create XML documents with the text and images tagged as per the stylesheets. The learning curve for XML, however, is a bit steep, and we can't visualise art directors spending time tagging text and images and importing them. Again, in Quark, the number of tagged styles available for XML in the default file were limited; so unless you create an XML document of your own, the number of styles that you can tag are limited. InDesign too offers XML tagging features and is more intuitive in that respect—you can directly create tags as per stylesheets or conversely make tags and add stylesheets to them.



With InDesign, column formats do not render as well as is evident from the text wrapping that's gone haywire



You can create a Web document directly in Quark and apply a number of effects. The export to HTML renders it quite well



Quark is still a bit behind in the ease of use as far as XML tagging is concerned



InDesign is quite intuitive when it comes to tagging text and generating an XML output

In PDF conversion, InDesign has an innate superiority and comes with a number of options. Quark, on the other hand, has no PDF converter of its own, and has to use Adobe Distiller to manage the conversions. InDesign also offers other export formats such as SVG (scalable vector graphics).

With the introduction of colour management systems in both software, reproduction is enhanced. You can now ensure that the colours that you see in Photoshop remain the same in InDesign or Quark. You can turn colour management on or off as per your requirement and specify the profiles to use during output. Earlier versions of InDesign had reported problems while creating output to positives and many designers feel that drop shadows and different transparencies may lead to more problems. Adobe claims it has resolved the issues and comes with a guide on how to flatten the drop shadow images before outputting. It also comes with an overprint preview that lets you know how exactly the colours have blended. InDesign wins round 4 too.

Score: Adobe 1 Quark 0

Round 5: Ease of use

Both these software retain the same look and the only difference you will notice in Quark's interface are the tools for tables and a scissor tool in the main

